Go To Mary:
Fifteen Promises of the Rosary

With Step-by-step Rosary Instructions



The Importance of Family Prayer

Father Patrick Peyton preached these profound words from his heart, “The first sentence of our Holy Rosary is worth all the gold of the Earth, and this is what it is and what I heard as a little child: ‘I believe in God.’" When it came to teaching on the Rosary and spreading the message about the importance of family prayer many said Father Peyton had a single-minded focus.

Family prayer, especially the Rosary, is a solid foundation to build a faithful family—a family on the Rock of faith, alongside Mary. We can go to Mary, a link between heaven and earth in our every need. The Rosary is that chain linking the heavenly kingdom with our earthly one. As Father Peyton, himself said, "The Rosary is a chain that binds the family together."

October is the Month of the Rosary. This is a perfect time to strengthen prayer in your home by committing to the pray the Rosary together or introduce this beautiful, powerful prayer to your family. Whether you've been praying for years or are just learning of this special devotion, the Blessed Mother, wishes to walk alongside you and your family, especially when you pray the Rosary.

A Little History

Venerable Patrick Peyton began his ministry in 1942 with the goal of building family unity through daily prayer of the Rosary. Inspired by his own father who had a deep appreciation for family prayer, praying the Rosary became the foundation for the life of Father Peyton (1909-1992).

We at Family Rosary are ever so grateful Father Peyton’s family instilled in him the importance of family prayer. Now it can be part of your family’s tradition so you can fulfill Father Peyton’s vision, “The Family That Prays Together Stays Together.”

Family Rosary
HOLY CROSS
FAMILY MINISTRIES

The family that prays together stays together

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"There is no problem, no matter how difficult it is, whether temporal or above all spiritual, in the personal life of each one of us, of our families ... that cannot be solved by the Rosary. There is no problem, I tell you, no matter how difficult it is, that we cannot resolve by the prayer of the Holy Rosary."

~Sister Lucia dos Santos, one of the children to whom Our Lady appeared at Fatima.

The family that prays together stays together

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Introduction

With the Rosary, the Christian people sits at the school of Mary and is led to contemplate the beauty on the face of Christ and to experience the depths of his love. Through the Rosary the faithful receive abundant grace, as though from the very hands of the Mother of the Redeemer.

~Pope Saint John Paul II's Apostolic Letter, Rosarium Virginis Mariae, 2002.

St. Dominic de Guzman, the founder of the Order of Preachers (commonly called the Dominicans) was laboring without success to convert souls back to the one true faith, Our Lady gave him a powerful weapon, the Angelic Salutation and the pattern in which it should be prayed.

The Angelic Salutation has three parts according to St Thomas Aquinas, "The Angel gave one part, namely: "Hail, full of grace, the Lord is with you, blessed art you among women" [Lk 1:28]. The other part was given by Elizabeth, the mother of John the Baptist, namely: "Blessed is the fruit of your womb" [Lk 1:42].

The Church adds the third part, that is, "Mary," because the Angel did not say, "Hail, Mary," but "Hail, full of grace." But, as we shall see, this name, "Mary," according to its meaning agrees with the words of the Angels.

The Hail Mary or Angelical Salutation or Ave Maria in the time of St. Thomas consisted only of the present first part of the prayer. The second part—"Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners, now and at the hour of our death,"—was also added by the Church later.[1]



If St. Dominic would preach her Rosary and its meditations on the life of Christ, many souls would be converted from their error and saved through her intercession.

The Blessed Virgin said to him:

"Wonder not that you have obtained so little fruit by your labors, you have spent them on barren soil, not yet watered with the dew of Divine grace. When God willed to renew the face of the earth, He began by sending down on it the fertilizing rain of the Angelic Salutation. Therefore, preach my Psalter composed of 150 Angelic Salutations and 15 Our Fathers, and you will obtain an abundant harvest."

Blessed Alain de la Roche, one of the Dominican Fathers from the monastery at Dinan, in Brittany, is known for his work in restoring the Rosary, after the practice of praying it began to fade only a century after being instituted by St. Dominic. According to the tradition, Alain de la Roche received the following 15 promises to those who pray the Rosary devoutly from the Blessed Virgin Mary herself through a private revelation.

[1](https://isidore.co/aquinas/english/AveMaria.htm).



The Fifteen Promises of the Rosary

1. Those who faithfully serve me by the recitation of the Rosary shall receive signal graces.

2. I promise my special protection and the greatest graces to all those who shall recite the Rosary.

3. The Rosary shall be a powerful armor against hell. It will destroy vice, decrease sin, and defeat heresies.

4. The recitation of the Rosary will cause virtue and good works to flourish. It will obtain for souls the abundant mercy of God. It will withdraw the hearts of men from the love of the world and its vanities, and will lift them to the desire of eternal things. Oh, that souls would sanctify themselves by this means.

5. The soul which recommends itself to me by the recitation of the Rosary shall not perish.

6. Those who recite my Rosary devoutly, applying themselves to the consideration of its sacred mysteries, shall never be conquered by misfortune. In His justice, God will not chastise them; nor shall they perish by an unprovided death, i.e., be unprepared for heaven. Sinners shall convert. The just shall persevere in grace and become worthy of eternal life.

7. Those who have a true devotion to the Rosary shall not die without the sacraments of the Church.

8. Those who faithfully recite the Rosary shall have, during their life and at their death, the light of God and the plenitude of His graces. At the moment of death, they shall participate in the merits of the saints in paradise.



9. I shall deliver from purgatory those who have been devoted to the Rosary.

10. The faithful children of the Rosary shall merit a high degree of glory in heaven.

11. By the recitation of the Rosary you shall obtain all that you ask of me.

12. Those who propagate the holy Rosary shall be aided by me in their necessities.

13. I have obtained from my Divine Son that all the advocates of the Rosary shall have for intercessors the entire celestial court during their life and at the hour of their death.

14. All who recite the Rosary are my beloved children and the brothers and sisters of my only Son, Jesus Christ.

15. Devotion for my Rosary is a great sign of predestination.[2]

[2] From the Catechism of the Catholic Church, paragraph 600: "To God, all moments of time are present in their immediacy. When therefore he establishes his eternal plan of "predestination", he includes in it each person's free response to his grace..."



How To Pray the Rosary

The rosary itself is composed of 59 beads laced together with a crucifix and a pendant of Mary where the three strands meet. We divide praying the Rosary into six segments. The first segment is composed of the introductory prayers and that is followed by five decades—each consisting of announcing a Mystery (list included), one Our Father, ten Hail Marys, and one Glory Be.

Introductory Prayers

Make the Sign of the Cross:
In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Holding the Crucifix recite the Apostles' Creed:
I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died and was buried; he descended into hell; on the third day he rose again from the dead; he ascended into heaven, and is seated at the right hand of the God the Father Almighty; from there he will come again to judge the living and the dead. I believe in the Holy Spirit, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and life everlasting. Amen.

On the first bead say the Our Father:
Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name; thy kingdom come; thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread; and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us; and lead us not into temptation but deliver us from evil. Amen.



How To Pray the Rosary - continued

Next recite three Hail Marys:
Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb, Jesus. Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners, now and at the hour of our death. Amen.

Conclude introductory prayers with one Glory Be:
Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit. As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Praying the Five Decades of the Rosary

At the start of each decade, announce the Mystery (see list below) then say the Our Father. Recite one Hail Mary for each of the ten smaller beads while meditating on the Mystery. Then conclude with a Glory Be.

The Rosary is made up of twenty "mysteries" (significant events or moments in the life of Jesus and Mary), which, following the publication of the Apostolic Letter Rosarium Virginis Mariae, written by Pope St. John Paul II in 2002, are grouped into four series.

The first contains joyful mysteries (recited on Mondays and Saturdays); the second, the mysteries of light (Thursdays); the third, the sorrowful mysteries (Tuesdays and Fridays); and the fourth, the glorious mysteries (Wednesdays and Sundays).

"This indication is not intended to limit a rightful freedom in personal and community prayer, where account needs to be taken of spiritual and pastoral needs and of the occurrence of particular liturgical celebrations which might call for suitable adaptations" (Rosarium Virginis Mariae, 38).

(source: www.vatican.va/special/rosary/documents/misteri_en.html)



How To Pray the Rosary - continued

The Joyful Mysteries
1. The Annunciation
2. The Visitation
3. The Nativity
4. The Presentation
5. The Finding in the Temple

The Sorrowful Mysteries
1. The Agony in the Garden
2. The Scourging at the Pillar
3. The Crowning with Thorns
4. The Carrying of the Cross
5. The Crucifixion

The Glorious Mysteries
1. The Resurrection
2. The Ascension
3. The Descent of the Holy Spirit
4. The Assumption
5. The Coronation of Mary

The Luminous Mysteries
1. The Baptism of Jesus
2. The Wedding Feast of Cana
3. The Proclamation of the Kingdom
4. The Transfiguration
5. The Institution of the Eucharist

Concluding Prayers

Hail Holy Queen:
Hail, Holy Queen, Mother of Mercy, our life, our sweetness, and our hope. To thee do we cry, poor banished children of Eve: to thee do we send up our sighs, mourning and weeping in this valley of tears. Turn then, O most gracious Advocate, thine eyes of mercy toward us, and after this, our exile, show unto us the blessed fruit of thy womb, Jesus. O clement, O loving, O sweet Virgin Mary! Pray for us, O Holy Mother of God, that we may be made worthy of the promises of Christ. Amen.



How To Pray the Rosary - continued

Concluding Prayers

V. Pray for us, O holy Mother of God.
R. That we may be made worthy of the promises of Christ.
Let us pray: O God, whose Only Begotten Son, by his life, Death, and Resurrection, has purchased for us the rewards of eternal life, grant, we beseech thee, that while meditating on these mysteries of the most holy Rosary of the Blessed Virgin Mary, we may imitate what they contain and obtain what they promise, through the same Christ our Lord. Amen.

Conclude the Rosary with the Sign of the Cross.

GO TO MARY

A LINK BETWEEN HEAVEN AND EARTH

The family that prays together stays together

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This October, the Month of the Rosary:
"Go to Mary: A Link Between Heaven and Earth."
Grow in the faith with your family.

For a wealth of daily prayer resources for you and your family, join our Global Prayer Campaign filled with videos, eBooks, podcasts, prayers, reflections, and social posts—everything you need for a rich, faith-filled month.

Find all of your family prayer resources at FamilyRosary.org.

Keep an eye on:
Family Rosary @ familyrosary.org
Catholic Mom @ catholicmom.com
Museum of Family Prayer @ museumoffamilyprayer.com
and on our Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter sites too!
#FamilyPrayer #FamilyRosary #PraytheRosary #GoToMary



Bringing Families Together In Prayer

We hope the time you've spent reflecting with this material has been enriching. Continue to pray with your family every day, wherever you are.

For additional online resources for family prayer including additional e-books and the mobile Rosary App, please visit our website at FamilyRosary.org.

This e-book and all our resources represent a culmination of Father Peyton's passion for family unity through prayer. We hope our services will enhance your family's prayer life particularly remembering Father Peyton's famous words, "The family that prays together stays together."